
HS 263: Popular Culture in Modern India: A Historical Perspective

Course Code	HS 263
Course Name	Popular Culture in Modern India: A Historical Perspective
L-T-P-C	3-0-0-3
Prerequisites	Consent of the Instructor
Intended for	UG
Distribution	Semester
Approval	9th Senate (May 2016)

Course Contents

- History of Cricket [8 Lectures]
 - Unit 1: Race and Sport in Colonial India: Parsi cricket in India
 - Unit 2: Caste and Cricket in Colonial India: A Case Study of Palwankar Baloo
 - Unit 3: Class and Cricket: A Case Study of Maharaja Ranjitsinhji
- 2. Popular Musical Traditions and Technology [4 Lectures]
 - Unit 1: Oral Musical Traditions: A Survey (Bhands, Qawalls)
 - Unit 2: The Guru and the Gramophone Technology and Changes in Consumption of Music
- 3. Popular Visual Culture [10 Lectures]
 - Unit 1: What is Visual Culture?
 - Unit 2: Posters of National Leaders in the Colonial Period
 - Unit 3: Maps of India in Calendar Art
 - Unit 4: Cartoons and their impact: R.K. Laxmans Common Man
- 4. Popular Films History [7 Lectures]
 - Unit 1: Colonial Anxieties Regarding Film in India
 - Unit 2: Nation-building Cinema of the 1950s
 - Unit 3: The Idea of the Secular in Indian Films
 - Unit 4: Changing Portrayals of the Villain in India
- 5. Advertisements after Economic Liberalization [3 Lectures]
- 6. Food History [10 Lectures]
 - Unit 1: Food in Ancient and Medieval India
 - Unit 2: Migration Patterns and Changes in Food Consumption
 - Unit 3: What is Authentic Indian Cuisine?

Text Books

1. A.R. Venkatachalapathy, **In Those Days There was No Coffee: Writings in Cultural History**, Yoda Press, 2006.
2. Rohit Wanchoo and Mukesh Williams, **Representing India: Literature, Politics, and Identities**, Oxford University Press India, 2008.
3. Dilip M. Menon (ed.), **Cultural History of Modern India**, Social Science Press, 2011.

Readings

1. Vasudha Dalmia and Rashmi Sadana (eds.), **The Cambridge Companion to Modern Indian Culture**, Cambridge University Press, 2012.
2. Ashis Nandy, **The Tao of Cricket: On Games of Destiny and the Destiny of Games**, Oxford University Press, 2001.
3. Ramachandra Guha, **A Corner of a Foreign Field: The Indian History of a British Sport**, Picador, 2002.
4. Peter Manuel, **Cassette Culture: Popular Music and Technology in North India**, University of Chicago Press, 1993.
5. Christopher Pinney, **Photos of the Gods': The Printed Image and Political Struggle in India**, Reaktion Books, 2004.
6. Sumathi Ramaswami, **The Goddess and the Nation: Mapping Mother India**, Duke University Press, 2010.
7. Ravi S. Vasudevan (ed.), **Making Meaning in Indian Cinema**, Oxford University Press, 2001.
8. William Mazzarella, **Shoveling Smoke: Advertizing and Globalization in Contemporary India**, Duke University Press, 2003.
9. Rache Dwyer, **Picture Abhi Baaki Hai: Bollywood as a Guide to Modern India**, Hachette, New Delhi, 2014.
10. K.T. Achaya, **A Historical Dictionary of Indian Food**, Oxford University Press, 2003.
11. Lizzie Collingham, **Curry: A Tale of Cooks and Conquerors**, Vintage, 2006.
12. John Thieme and Ira Raja (eds.), **The Table is Laid: An Anthology of South Asian Food Writing**, Oxford University Press, 2007.
13. Utsa Ray, **Culinary Culture in Colonial India: A Cosmopolitan Platter and the Middle-Class**, Cambridge University Press, 2015.
14. Arjun Appadorai, **How to Make a National Cuisine: Cookbooks in Contemporary India**, *Comparative Studies in Society and History*, vol.30, no.1, 1988.
15. Douglas Haynes et al (eds.), **Toward a History of Consumption in South Asia**, Oxford University Press, 2010.
16. R.K. Laxman, **Brushing up the Years: A Cartoonists History of India, 1947-2004**, Penguin Viking, 2005.
17. R.K. Laxman, **The Best of Laxman: The Common Man Casts his Vote**, Penguin, 2005.
18. Abu Abraham, **Why does Kerala produce so many cartoonists?** *India International Centre Quarterly*, Vol. 22, No 2/3, Summer-Monsoon 1995, pp. 60-764.
19. R.K. Laxman, **Freedom to Cartoon, Freedom to Speak**, *Daedalus: Another India*, Vol. 118, No 4, Fall 1989, pp. 68-791.